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UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMMAD MEETS WITH SERBIAN PRESIDENT

President His Highness Shaikh Mohammad Bin Zayed Al Nahyan attends a lunch reception hosted by Aleksandar Vucic, President of Serbia, during a working visit at The Bristol Hotel, Belgrade, yesterday. The leaders held talks focusing on various areas of cooperation, particularly in investment, economy, trade, technology, food security, renewable energy, and other sectors that serve the mutual interests and development priorities of both nations. **SEE ALSO P4**

52 nationalities can now drive in UAE with home licences

Exchange applies to various categories, including motorcycles and light vehicles

DUBAI
BY ALI AL HAMMADI
Reporter

The UAE Ministry of Interior has announced that residents of over 50 nationalities are permitted to drive vehicles in the country using their national driving licences during their visit, without the need for theoretical or practical testing — provided they are not residing in the UAE.

In its latest update, the ministry outlined six conditions for allowing individuals of these nationalities to exchange their national driving licences for a UAE driving licence in the case of residency:

- The licence must be issued by a country eligible for exchange.

NATIONALITIES THAT CAN AVAIL BENEFIT

Estonia, Albania, Portugal, China, Hungary, Greece, Ukraine, Bulgaria, Slovakia, Slovenia, Serbia, Cyprus, Latvia, Luxembourg, Lithuania, Malta, Iceland, Montenegro, Israel, Azerbaijan, Belarus, Uzbekistan, USA, France, Japan, Belgium, Switzerland, Germany, Italy, Sweden, Ireland, Spain, Norway, New Zealand, Romania, Singapore, Hong Kong, the Netherlands, Denmark, Austria, Finland, UK, Turkey, Canada, Poland, South Africa, Australia, Croatia, Texas, North Macedonia, Kosovo, Kyrgyz Republic, in addition to citizens of South Korea, who can only exchange their driver licences issued by their countries for a UAE license when residing in the UAE.

sued by a country eligible for exchange.

- The applicant must meet the legal age requirement for driving.

- The licence must be valid.

- The applicant must hold a residency visa issued by the relevant emirate or have a verified residential, work, or study address in that emirate.

- The applicant must pass an eye test.

- For some countries, the original licence must be surrendered based on memorandums of understanding.

The ministry clarified that licence recognition refers to the use of national driving licences within the UAE when the person is a non-resident, while licence exchange refers to replacing a national driving licence with a UAE-issued licence during legal residency.

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UAE firms get tax break on properties

THEY CAN DEDUCT DEPRECIATION ON FAIR-VALUE INVESTMENT PROPERTIES

DUBAI

BY JUSTIN VARGHESE
Your Money Editor

The UAE Ministry of Finance has issued a new rule allowing companies to deduct depreciation on investment properties held at fair value — a move that brings these firms in line with those using a historical cost method for accounting.

The Ministerial Decision applies under the UAE's Corporate Tax Law (Federal Decree-Law No. 47 of 2022) and provides clarity for how tax deductions can be claimed on such properties starting from tax periods beginning on or after January 1, 2025.

Under the new rule:

- Taxpayers can deduct depreciation from their taxable income, but only if they choose the “realisation basis” method and make an irrevocable election in their first eligible tax period.

- The deduction allowed will be the lower of 4 per cent of the original cost or the written-down value of the property, calculated over each 12-month period or prorated for shorter time frames.

- This option is available to taxpayers owning investment properties either before or after the corporate tax law took effect.

The Ministry noted that the decision helps ensure parity between taxpayers who use fair value and those who follow historical cost accounting, as the latter already benefit from accounting depreciation.

The Ministry noted that the decision helps ensure parity between taxpayers who use fair value and those who follow historical cost accounting, as the latter already benefit from accounting depreciation.

One-time window

There's also an exceptional one-time window for businesses that haven't yet opted for the realisation basis to do so — allowing them to take advantage of this tax deduction opportunity.

The Ministry added that clear guidance has been issued on “claw-back” scenarios — when previously claimed depreciation might need to be reversed, such as in cases other than property disposals.

This step is part of the UAE's wider goal to create a neutral, transparent, and globally aligned tax framework for businesses operating in the country. **SEE ALSO P5**



SPORT

Why Jasprit Bumrah must play the fourth Test

Pacer's presence could make the difference | P13

Robots deliver goods via Metro in China test run

Goal to enhance efficiency, reduce costs

DUBAI

BY BALARAM MENON
Senior Web Editor

In a groundbreaking pilot test, a team of delivery robots successfully used the Metro system to transport goods to shops located within Wanxia Station on Shenzhen Metro Line 2, China Daily reported.

The trial marks a significant step toward streamlining underground commercial logistics.

Traditionally, deliveries to metro shops rely on human workers hauling goods from trucks parked above ground — an



approach often slowed by limited parking and morning traffic congestion.

These new robots, equipped with AI-powered dispatch systems, panoramic lidar, and advanced chassis designs, navigate the metro during off-peak hours. The goal is to reduce delivery costs and improve efficiency for shop owners.



Watch:
Robots deliver goods

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